StarDust

+

StarPower!

PREMISE – Solid, Liquid, and Gas Series

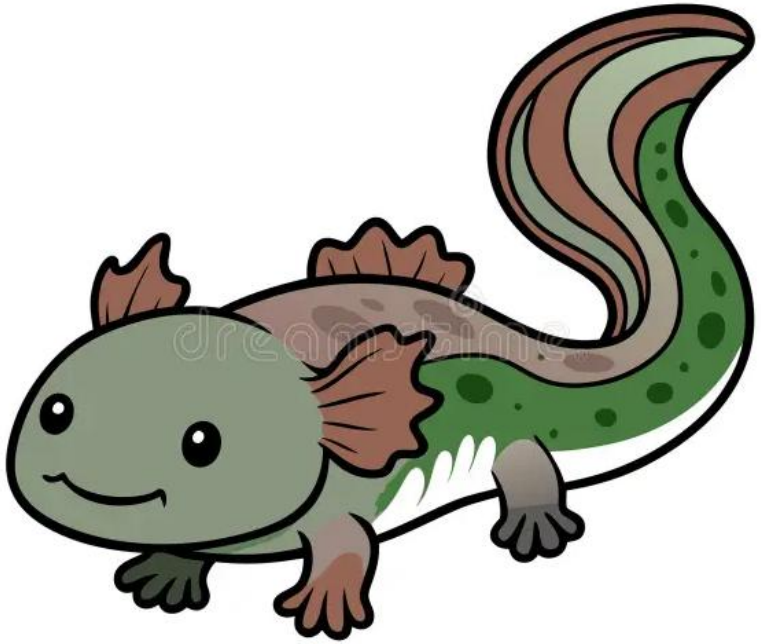
A Mac and Cheese Network (MCN) franchise created by River Matthews and Skye Park. It combines concepts from child development and early childhood education with animation and cardboard to help their viewers learn. The series was originally hosted by Billy Clayton Dubois as Clay, who left in 2006 leading to its cancellation until being replaced by Ms. Aurora Sterling as Aurora for the 2026 reboot.

Stardust (1999 – 2006) is a live-action/animated educational series where a cosmic mudpuppy named Stardust leaves glitter to help her human friend (Clay) and the viewer explore the galaxy and learn science.

Its 2026 reboot spinoff, *StarPower!*, follows her bigger axolotl sister, StarPower, who uses her powers with the help of Stardust, her explorer friend (Aurora, Clay's cousin) and the viewer to save planets in trouble.

STARDUST

A cosmic green mudpuppy and StarPower's little sister who uses her powers to leave glitter for her space explorer friends to find their way through the planets or comets they are visiting.



STARPOWER

A cosmic pink axolotl and Stardust's bigger sister who uses her powers to help comets, planets, and stars that are in trouble. She can make herself bigger than stars.

CLAY

The original host of *Stardust.*

AURORA

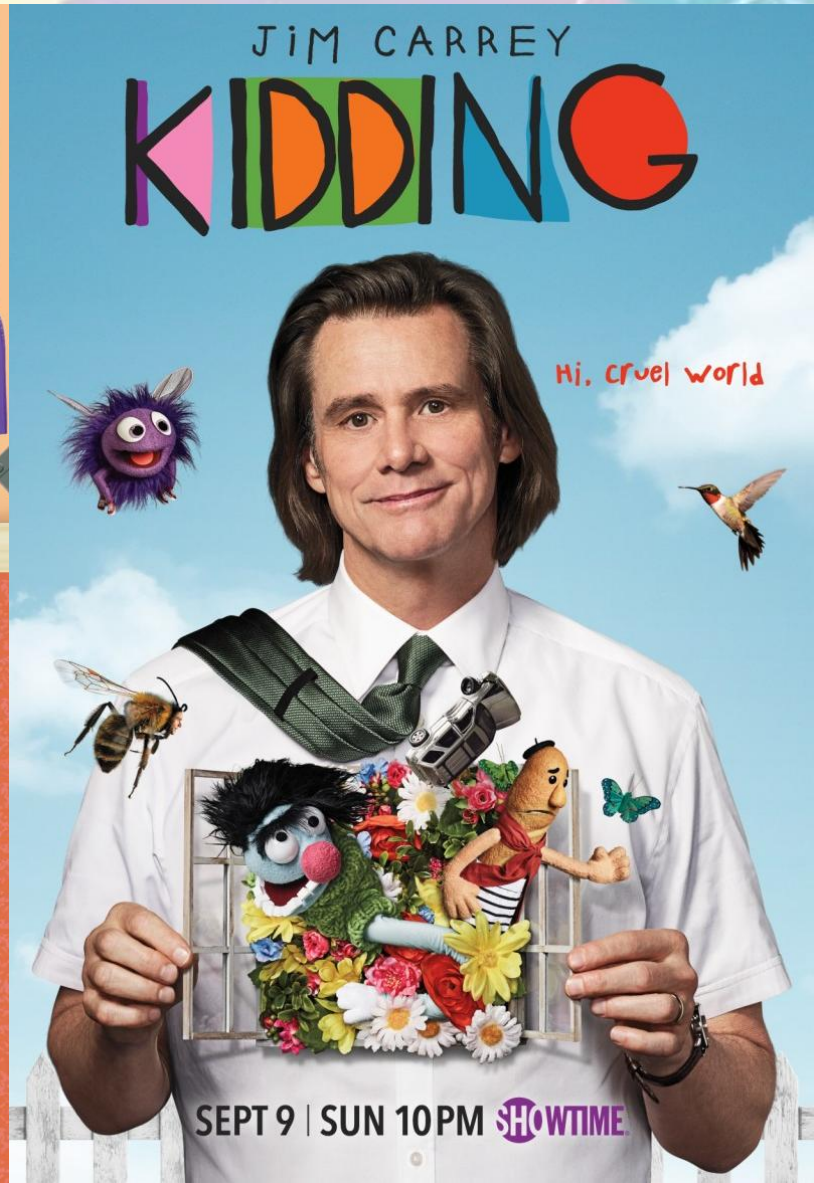
The host of StarPower!

RAY

Aurora’s sister and sidekick who sometimes stops by.

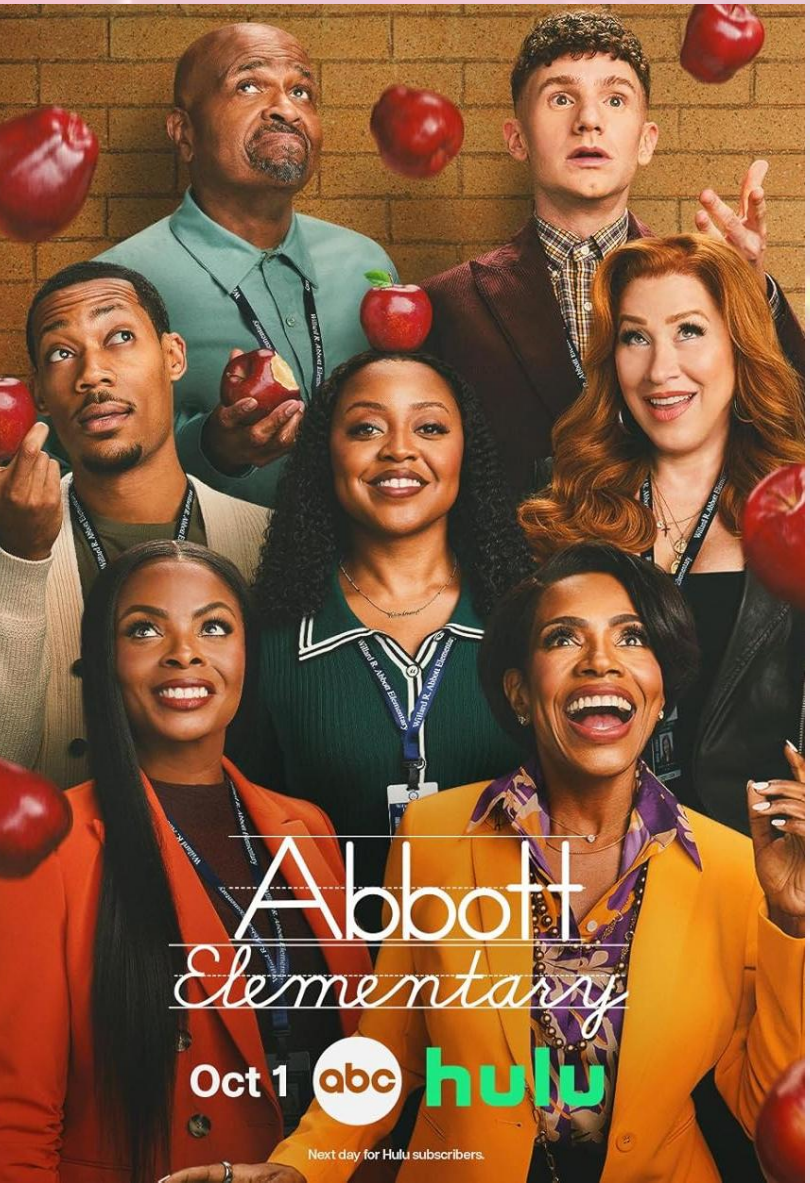
COMPS **Half-Hour Dramedy** **A bit Musical** **A bit Animated**

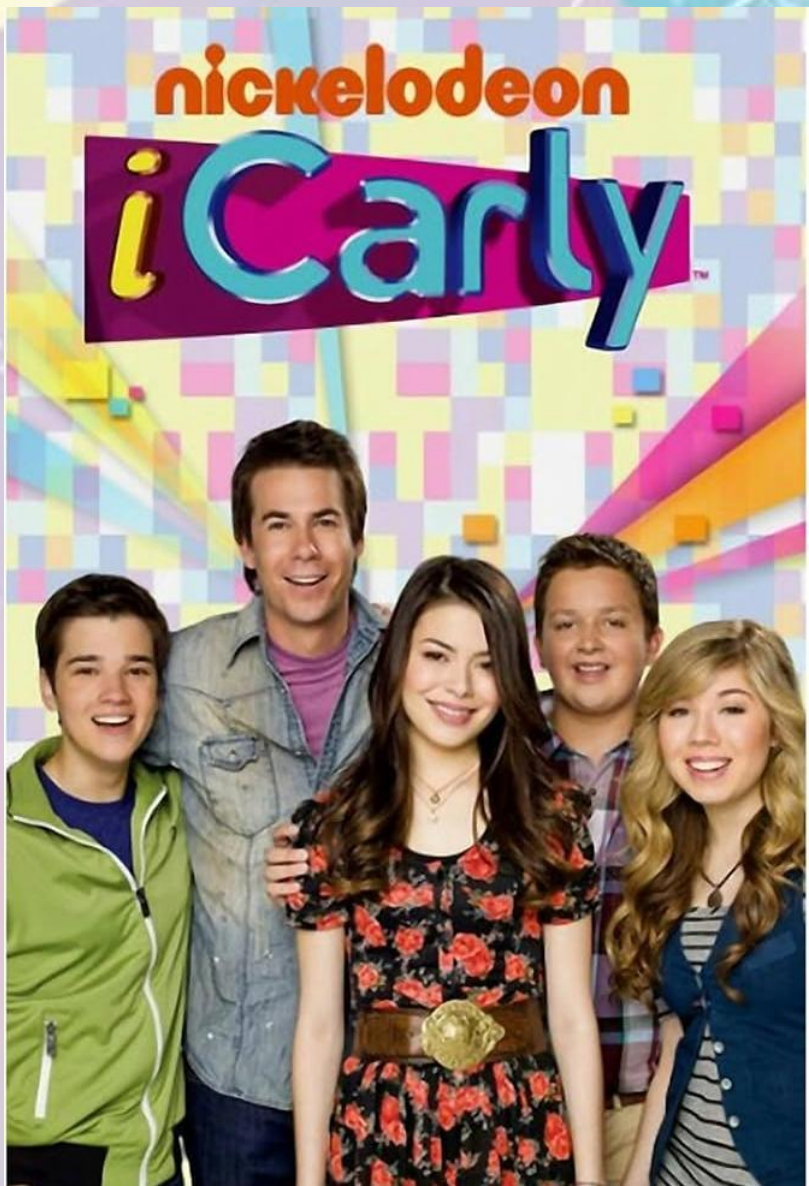
chaos of *The Bear* meets magic of *Blue's Clues* meets dark reality of *Kidding*



COMPS2 Serialized Season 1 Episodic After Mockumentary

mockumentary of *Abbott* meets science of *Magic School Bus* meets slapstick of *iCarly*





MAIN TITLE:

cosm

PILOT EPISODE: MILKY WAY

cosm

27 EPISODES

Season 1

1. Inner Child → 2. Who Does Not Belong? → 3. Write and Wrong → 4. For Educational Purposes Only → 5. Autopilot → 6. Listening Ears → 7. A Safe World → 8. Won't You Be My Enemy? → 9. Sublime → 10. A Chain Reaction → 11. Save the Children → 12. The Boiling Point → 12. Outer Child

Season 2

1. Back on Earth → 2. Burnout → 3. Hosts of War → 4. Loud on Set → 5. Community Guidelines → 6. We All Matter → 7. Unscripted → 8. Opening Night → 9. Wish for Granted

Season 3

1. Absolute Zero → 2. Solid → 3. Liquid → 4. Gas → 5. Plasma → 6. Prima Materia

SEASON 1 (Episode 1 - 5)

Ray, a struggling educator, finds inspiration from her childhood hero, *Stardust* host, Clay. She learns the show is being revived as *StarPower!*, but the creators plan to hire her rival, Ms. Aurora, without auditions. Her brother Kwan helps Ray reconnect with Clay. Initially turning her down, he decides to be her mentor upon finding out about the revival without his knowledge.

Amongst 3000 auditions, Ray performs well, but the network ultimately chooses the polished Ms. Aurora as the host. But due to public outcry, Ray is hired as a writer with a guest appearances as Aurora’s sidekick, which is designed to sideline her, leading to personality clashes on set.

Ray struggles to adapt to the show's rigid format, having a hard time pausing for children's responses. But she refines her hosting style after realizing her direct approach resonates with neurodivergent viewers like her brother.

SEASON 1 (Episode 6 - 9)

An ideological rift forms when Aurora uses her platform to discuss climate change, while Ray is neutral on sensitive topics to stay on the network's good graces. The public sees Aurora as brave and Ray as a coward. Ray decides to be a guest appearance on a conservative children's show in an attempt to reach a challenging audience. This backfires, leading to a confrontation with a stressed progressive Aurora and Ray's eventual firing by the network.

The network brings back Clay as a recurring character, but Aurora suspects he plans to undermine her. Meanwhile, Ray volunteers at her brother's neurodivergent theatre, learning humility and that her role is to support others and to *listen*. Aurora goes on strike and forces the network to rehire Ray, though Ray opts to simply return as a writer.

SEASON 1 (Episode 10 - 11)

Following their shared ordeal, Ray and Aurora reconcile and become friends. Ray celebrates turning 30 and crashes her car much like Clay on his 29th birthday. This time, Skye takes the blame and gets suspended from the show. Just before the first season finale begins filming, Aurora accepts the host position of *Science* and quits *StarPower!* The co-creators, River and Skye, are about to pull the plug, but Ray returns to take the mantle.

Ray hosts her first solo episode for the season finale, by a crowd of anti-science protesters gathered outside the studio. She masters the pause technique she previously struggled with, speaking her truth to the camera and receiving a positive response from children worldwide. Unknown to her, Clay is plotting to reclaim the hosting spot, and remove her with the show creators, setting up Ray as the active target of the next season.

SEASON 2 (Episode 1 - 6)

Ray debuts as the host of the second season of *StarPower!* to high ratings. However, things turn toxic when Clay returns as a consultant. He suggests to the network that she is cracking under pressure during a grueling filming schedule for both the show and a new feature film, *Star Goes to Earth*.

After a tabloid leaks a video of Ray and Aurora fighting at a children's media convention, their networks force them on a kindness press tour, where they become enemies again. Aurora discovers Clay is sabotaging Ray but allows it to continue as she is against *Stardust*'s network's political stances.

Harsh filming conditions and encounters with hostile anti-science activists cause Ray's mental state to spiral. After a fire on set that shakes Ray to her core, the network forces her to take a mental health break. In her absence, Clay hosts several hollow specials that cause viewership to drop.

SEASON 2 (Episode 7 - 9)

Ray finds an unreleased VHS tape showing Clay having a breakdown on set years ago. She confronts him, feeling he is sabotaging her because he fears her success would make his legacy obsolete.

Ray asks Aurora to return as herself on the film, *Star Goes to Earth*. She accepts and brings her musical talents. She also uses the film to advocate for the environment and wellbeing of children everywhere.

In the Season 3 premiere of *StarPower!*, a terminally ill child actor named Grant guest stars. Clay officially retires, passing his signature cosmic vest to Grant. Despite Grant's wish for the show to continue, the network abruptly cancels the series, leaving only five produced episodes for the final season. Ray announces this news on a book signing tour. Meanwhile, Kwan is given an opportunity to audition for an acclaimed science documentary series.

SEASON 3 (Episode 1 - 5)

Ray learns the *StarPower!* cancellation was due to the FCC's anti-science views. Years pass, with such sentiment growing in the nation's government.

Nearly a decade later in 2038, a natural disaster reunites the *Stardust* team as spokespersons. The nation faces massive education funding cuts. During a gathering in support of teachers, an anti-activist driver runs over Ms. Aurora, making the fight for science a matter of life and death.

In 2039, Ray uses *Stardust*'s 40th anniversary to deliver an inspiring message about education. This message prompts thousands of adult *Stardust* fans to march on the capitol, demanding funding restoration. The series ends with Ray attending the premiere of a science series created by her brother, Kwan.

DAVID QUANG PHAM (HEAD WRITER)

An award-winning songwriter, theatre and filmmaker who personifies science to explore social issues and the human condition. His 2025 highlights include the world premiere of his stage musicals *Turnover: A New Leaf* and *Chemicals in the Water*, alongside high-profile film fellowships with Cinephila and Kellogg's Foundation. An astrophysics and theatre graduate from Michigan State University, his musical style blends pop, punk, and Vietnamese folk. Beyond writing, they're a versatile musician performing with Queer Big Apple Corps and recording for Apple TV's *Severance*.

(PRODUCERS)

(DIRECTORS)

THE IMPORTANCE

We are living through a cultural moment. It's three decades since the premiere of *Blue's Clues*, a show that changed how we processed the world through kindness and the pauses/invitation for us to participate. For many like me, Steve inspired us to believe that the universe was a puzzle we could solve, together. It meant the world when Steve delivered this message to us all in 2021. Today's generation is growing up in a post-truth world defined by climate anxiety, scientific skepticism, and suicidal social media. *Solid, Liquid, and Gas* is a direct response to this.

The story investigates the states of matter (solid, liquid, gas, plasma) as metaphors for personal transformation. While solids are fixed and liquids flow and gases fill, plasma is high-energy, volatile, and luminating (Ray's chaotic yet brilliant approach to education). The *Stardust* team includes Clay, the original host; River and Skye, the co-creators and voice actors; and Ms. Aurora, the new host. The emotional anchor is Kwan, Ray's neurodivergent brother and an astronomy prodigy.

AND IT'S JUST... IT'S
JUST SO AMAZING, RIGHT?

PREMISE – The Real World

Stardust + StarPower! **is a live-action/animated educational series where an interstellar mudpuppy named Stardust and her giant axolotl sister StarPower leave glitter to help her human companion (Aurora) and the viewer explore the universe. They also use their powers to save planets in trouble.**

INSPIRATION

Since 2014, David Quang Pham is an active supporter of neurodivergent children's theatres like Openspot Theatre (once 4th Wall Theatre Company).

One of David's theatre professors (anonymous) was on the shortlist to host *Blue's Clues*. As of 2015, they are still upset about losing to Steve Burns.

David, VP of Michigan State's Sigma Pi Sigma chapter, physics honor society; and volunteer at Impression 5 Science Center.

David (7) at Space Camp, Huntsville, Alabama

A LITTLE SCIENTIST'S DREAM

Andrea M. Ghez, 2020 Nobel Prize in Physics
David studied in guest Dr. Ghez's class in 2015.

Let's Create the Universe Together

David Quang Pham

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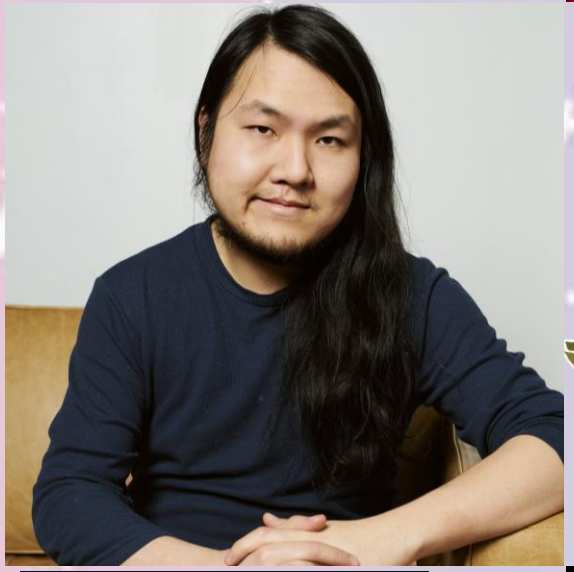
2024 Great Performances Award. Dr. Meisha Porter - 30th Chancellor, NYC Dept. of Ed - presented grant to engage the public in STEM with musical theatre.



David adapted his award-winning musical *Turnover: A New Leaf* into an animated feature and series: Photosynthesis